

HOUSE No. 3980

The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

PRESENTED BY:

Carmine Lawrence Gentile

To the Honorable Senate and House of Representatives of the Commonwealth of Massachusetts in General Court assembled:

The undersigned legislators and/or citizens respectfully petition for the adoption of the accompanying bill:

An Act establishing LGBTQIA+ parent advisory councils in the Commonwealth.

PETITION OF:

NAME:	DISTRICT/ADDRESS:	DATE ADDED:
<i>Carmine Lawrence Gentile</i>	<i>13th Middlesex</i>	<i>2/21/2025</i>
<i>Liz Miranda</i>	<i>Second Suffolk</i>	<i>2/26/2025</i>
<i>James B. Eldridge</i>	<i>Middlesex and Worcester</i>	<i>6/12/2025</i>
<i>Vanna Howard</i>	<i>17th Middlesex</i>	<i>6/25/2025</i>
<i>Patricia D. Jehlen</i>	<i>Second Middlesex</i>	<i>11/12/2025</i>
<i>Patrick Joseph Kearney</i>	<i>4th Plymouth</i>	<i>5/20/2025</i>
<i>Samantha Montañó</i>	<i>15th Suffolk</i>	<i>3/5/2025</i>

HOUSE No. 3980

By Representative Gentile of Sudbury, a petition (subject to Joint Rule 12) of Carmine Lawrence Gentile, Liz Miranda and Samantha Montañó for legislation to establish LGBTQIA+ parent advisory councils in public schools. Education.

The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

In the One Hundred and Ninety-Fourth General Court
(2025-2026)

An Act establishing LGBTQIA+ parent advisory councils in the Commonwealth.

Be it enacted by the Senate and House of Representatives in General Court assembled, and by the authority of the same, as follows:

1 SECTION 1. Chapter 71 of the General Laws is hereby amended by inserting after
2 section 1D the following section:

3 Section 1E. Notwithstanding any general or special law to the contrary, the school
4 committee of any city, town, or school district shall establish a LGBTQIA+ (Lesbian, Gay,
5 Bisexual, Transgender, Queer, Intersex, Asexual, or another identity on the Queer spectrum)
6 parent advisory council. Membership shall be offered to all parents who identify themselves as
7 LGBTQIA+ or have children who identify as LGBTQIA+, and other interested parties.

8 The duties of the council shall include, but not be limited to: (i) advising the school
9 committee on matters that pertain to the education and safety of LGBTQIA+ students; (ii)
10 meeting regularly with school officials to participate in the planning, development and
11 evaluation of the school district's programs; (iii) participating in the review of school
12 improvement plans under section 59C of chapter 71 and district improvement plans under

section 1I of chapter 69. Upon request from a parent advisory council, each school committee or school council within that parent advisory council's district shall meet at least annually with the council; provided, however, that if the parent advisory council advises a charter school the board of the charter school shall, upon request from the parent advisory council, meet not less than annually with the council. The parent advisory council shall establish by-laws regarding officers and operational procedures. In the course of its duties under this section, the council shall receive assistance from the school committee without charge, upon reasonable notice, and subject to the availability of staff and resources. SECTION 2. The department of elementary and secondary education shall adopt, promulgate, amend and rescind rules and regulations or formulate policies and make recommendations as necessary to implement this act. SECTION 3. This act shall take effect on January 1, 2027